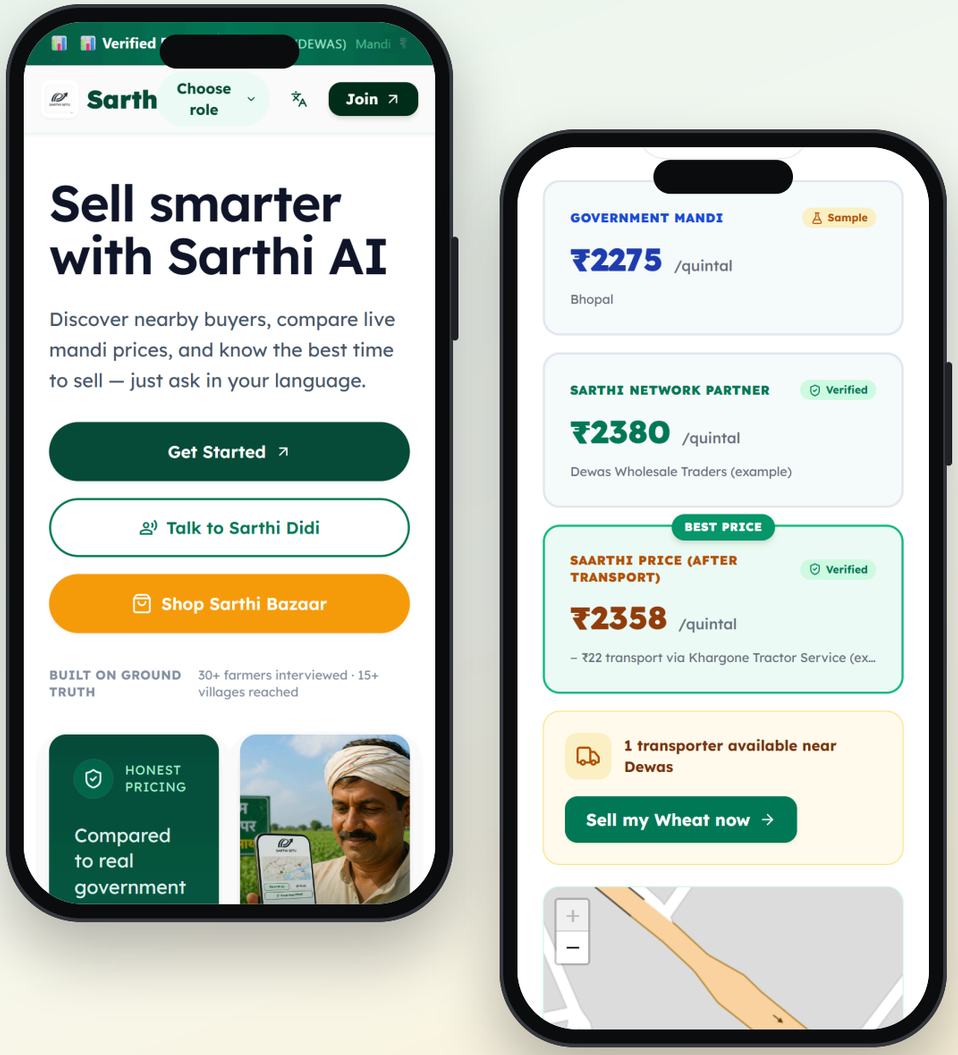
Teardown: Saarthi

Device: Mobile web, voice-first, Indian languages

Goal: Replace phone-call coordination between farmers, buyers and transporters

Read: 8 minutes

Author: Godhuli Vyas, founder



Saarthi's Overview

Saarthi is a **voice-first agri-logistics app** for farmers. A farmer says what they harvested, sees honest mandi and buyer prices, and books nearby transport, without typing a form. Built through the Polygnan YouStart Fellowship and now live.

Sarvam AI (Indic STT/TTS) | React | Vercel | Dispatch workflow

Key Insights:

Voice, not forms: Indic speech-to-text and TTS let low-literacy users transact by talking. Sarthi Didi guides a first-time user.

Dispatch first: the MVP was scoped to dispatch, and price discovery was deliberately cut from the first scope.

Honest pricing: each price is a real government rate or a real buyer-listed offer, never a guess.

The problem: Five Whys

Saarthi

01
Why 1
Farmers sell crops right after harvest.

→

02
Why 2
They need cash now and cannot wait for a better price.

→

03
Why 3
Affordable storage and warehouses are out of reach.

→

04
Why 4
They do not know about warehouses, FPOs and schemes.

→

05
Why 5
No simple guidance on price, storage, logistics or schemes.

Reframe (from the fellowship research sheet): the first idea was farm-to-consumer transport. The root cause turned out to be missing information and guidance for farmers, so the product moved from logistics alone to information plus logistics, in local language.

What the field research found

300+

field conversations

Site claim, across three sides of the market

70%

of delay from phone coordination

Site claim, observed delays

15+

interviews logged in the tracker

Fellowship requirement, met

30

users reached at final check

Tracker, Week 10 readiness sheet

The tracker and the site count differently: the tracker logs 15+ interviews and 30 users reached; the 300+ and 70% figures are the founder's own claims on the portfolio.

Who it is for

R

Ramesh Patidar, 48

Primary persona: small farmer, Khargone, MP (from the research sheet)

Owns a small plot, grows wheat and vegetables, little formal education. **Goal:** stable income, better prices, fewer middlemen. **Pain:** no storage, unpredictable mandi prices, unaware of schemes. **Habit:** sells at the local mandi right after harvest; uses the phone for calls and WhatsApp. "We sell crops immediately after harvest because we cannot afford to wait for better prices."

V

Vikram, trader and fleet owner

Composite persona from field research

Built from buyer, trader and transporter conversations (not a real individual). **Goal:** reliable supply and predictable quality, not just the lowest price. **Pain:** transport is fragmented and arranged by phone; labour for loading is hard to find in peak season. **Habit:** negotiates in the mandi and by call. Wants verified farmers and a full load both ways.

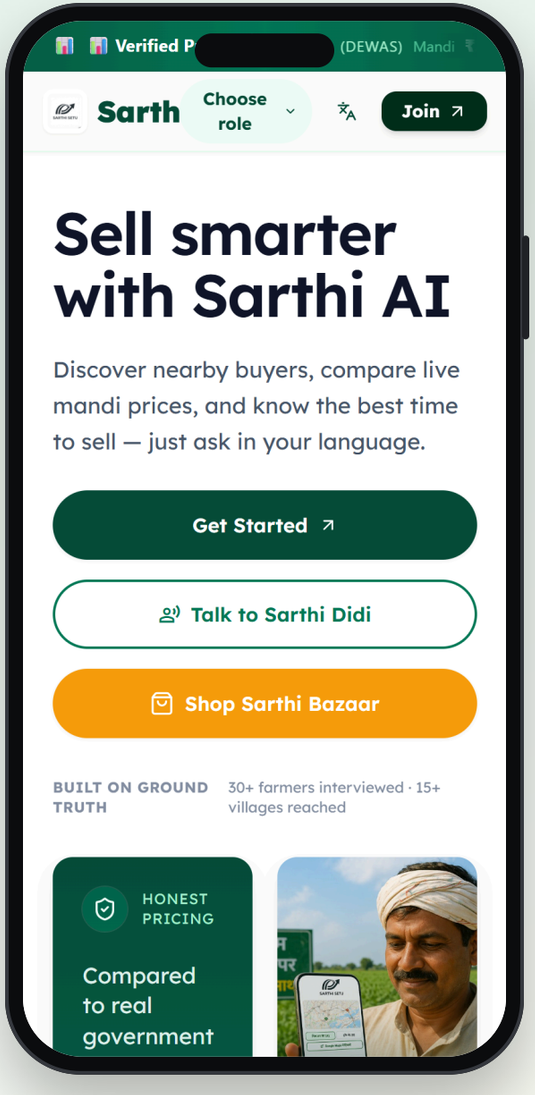
User stories (derived from field research)

Saarthi

As a	I want	So that	Traced to
Farmer	a price alert before I dispatch	I do not transport a crop to a low bhaav	Interviews: good rate only some days, price changes daily
Farmer	to book a mandi slot online	I do not lose a day in the queue	Interviews: no slot booking, queue waits
Small farmer	shared transport and pickup pooling	a small lot does not carry the same truck cost	Interviews: one tractor, 50 quintal, about Rs 2,500
Farmer	a direct buyer and a nearby warehouse	I am not forced into a distress sale	Interviews: trader-controlled price, no storage

User Journey: the first screen

Saarthi



Home

A language chooser opens first, so the user picks their own language before anything else.

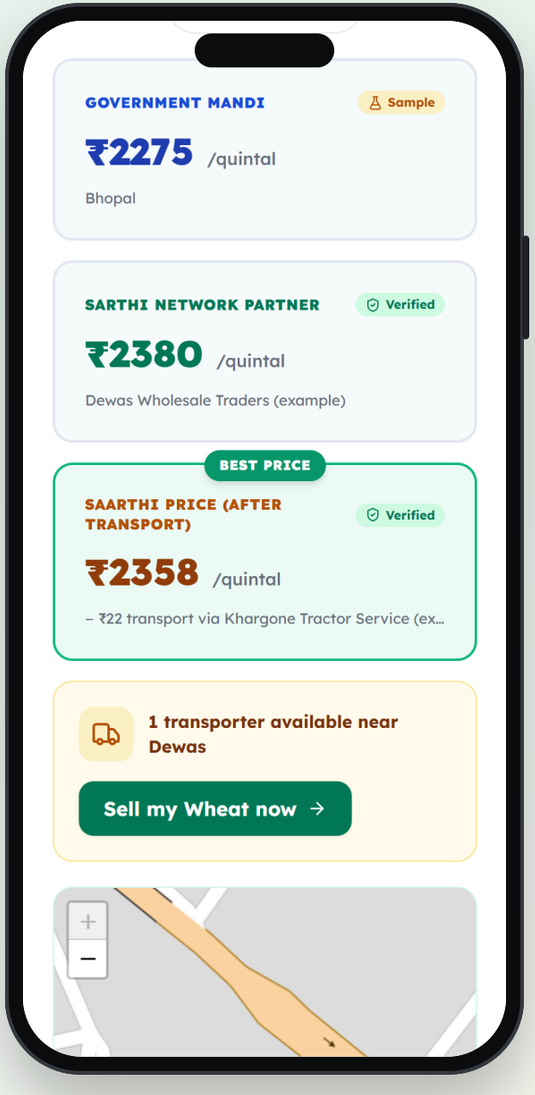
The hero promise is plain: **"Sell smarter with Sarthi AI"**, with three actions: Get Started, **Talk to Sarthi Didi** (voice), and Shop Sarthi Bazaar.

Proof sits below it: **318+ registered farmers** and **36+ grains to vegetables**.

Solution: Voice is a top-level button, not a hidden feature.

User Journey: see the price before you sell

Saarthi



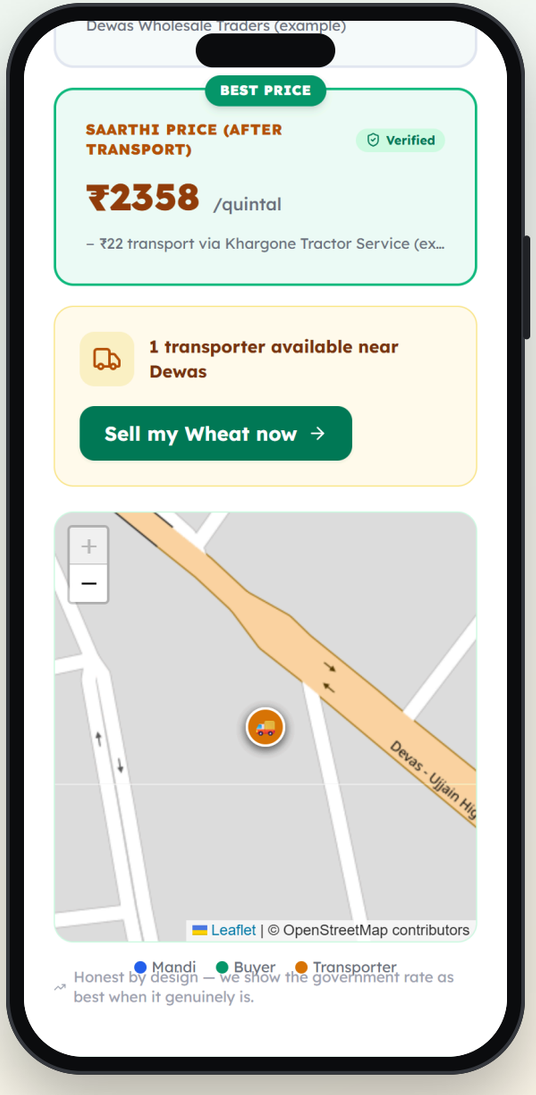
Live prices

The farmer picks a crop and a place, and sees the **government mandi rate** next to a **Sarthi network buyer offer**.

A **best price after transport** card nets out the haulage cost, so the comparison is honest.

Some cards are labelled Sample, so the data is not all live yet.

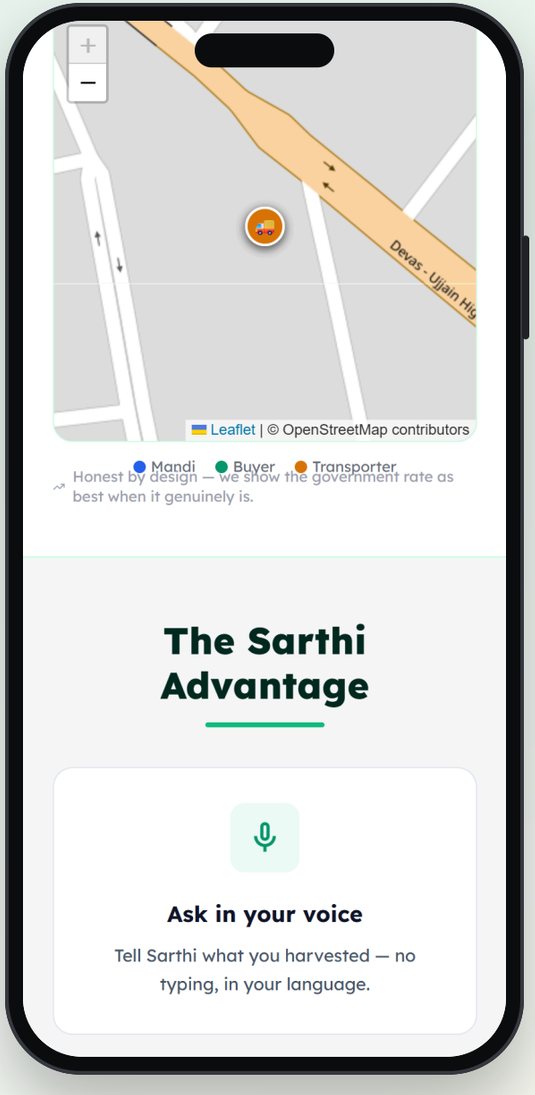
Solution: Show the net price, not the headline price.



Best price

User Journey: book and decide

Saarthi



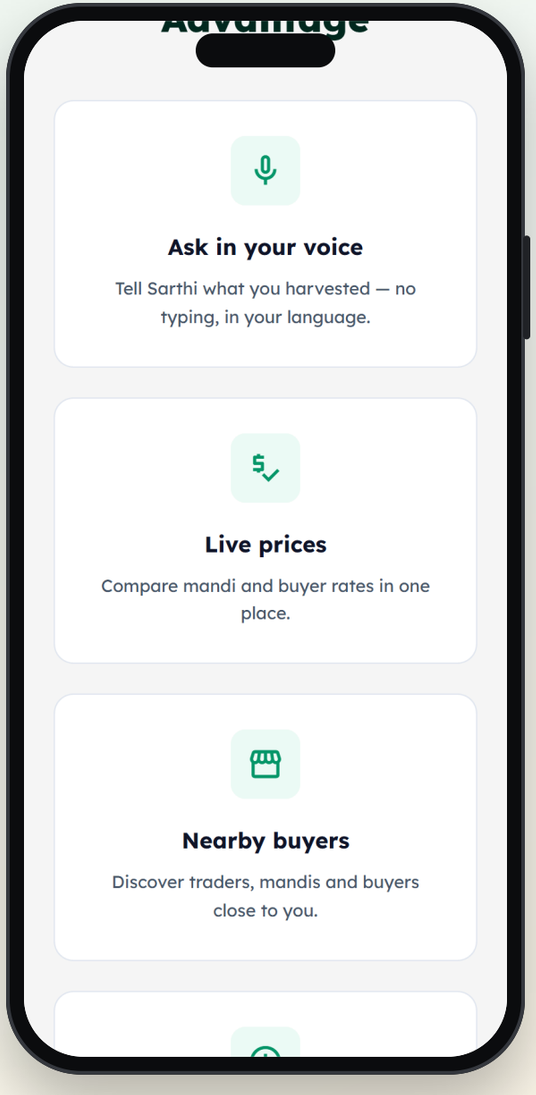
Nearby transport

"**1 transporter available near Dewas**" with a **Sell my Wheat now** button turns a price into a booking.

A map shows mandis, buyers and transporters near the farmer.

Four promises: **ask in your voice, live prices, nearby buyers, smart timing** (sell today or wait).

Solution: One screen links price, buyer and truck, which is what phone calls did before.



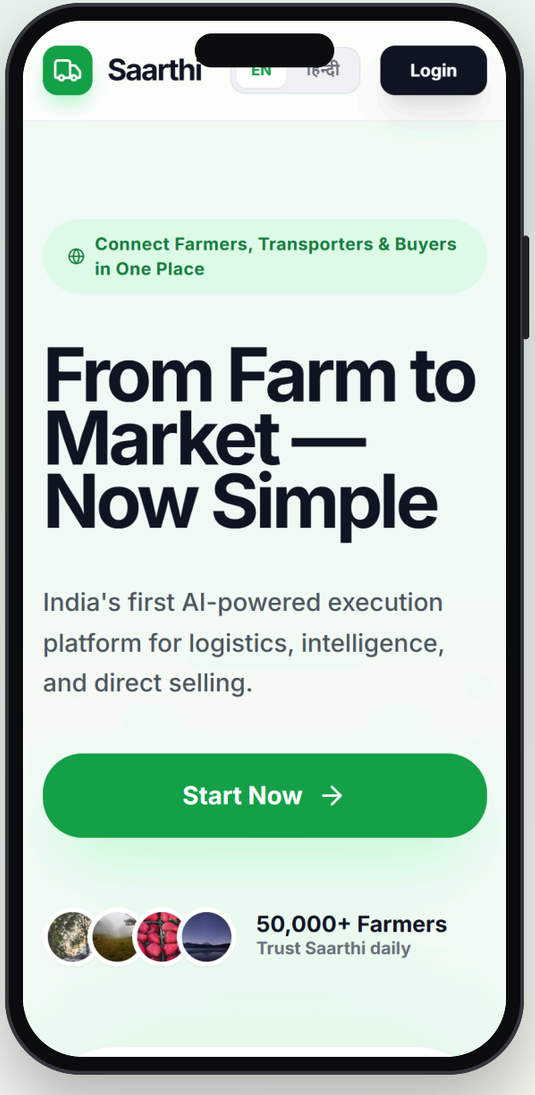
The advantage

Iteration: v1, v2 and the final build

Saarthi

Version	What it had	Left out or weak	What came next
v1 (Week 5)	Live mandi prices, farmer, buyer and transporter dashboards, booking request, multilingual UI, voice concept	Real payments, OTP login, maps booking, backend automation, analytics	Prototype-level UI, weak trust layer
v2 (Week 7)	Full redesign, OTP onboarding, persona onboarding, language toggle, cleaner dashboards	Removed cluttered screens and placeholder content	Added maps pickup and drop, payment flow, logistics lead matching, wallet concept
Final	Voice-first: Sarthi Didi, Sarthi Bazaar, honest price comparison with transport netted in	Advanced AI automation, enterprise backend, deep analytics	Pilot with real transactions

v1 and v2, side by side



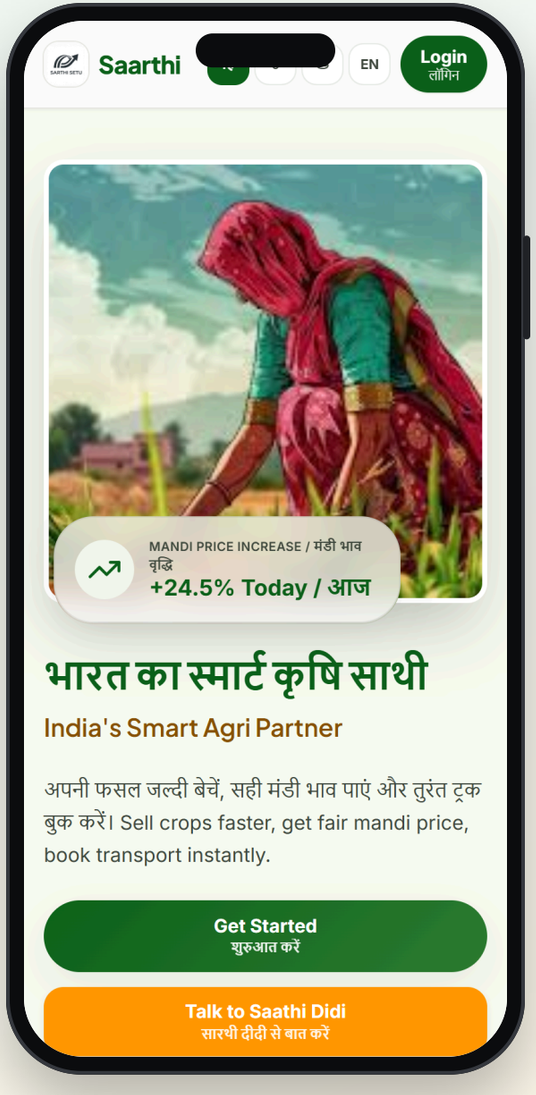
v1: role chooser

v1 asked **Farmer, Transporter, Buyer or Admin** up front, a clean idea, but still a prototype.

Tester feedback on v1 (aggregate): **pickup location edit failed, mandi and crop prices were incomplete, trust and buyers were the real question.**

v2 added OTP, Hindi and English, and a booking flow. **Its hero numbers were placeholder claims and are not carried into the final.**

Solution: The final build swapped big placeholder stats for real counts and a live price tool.



v2: redesign

GTM learnings

Saarthi

1

Trust beats tech

Founder-led in-person onboarding worked best. App-first, passive digital acquisition underperformed.

2

WhatsApp and calls

Most people preferred WhatsApp or a call to an app install. Distribution had to match behaviour.

3

Relief before vision

Users adopt when Saarthi solves today's pain: transport, price, buyer access.

GTM plan and economics (tracker)

Saarthi

>

Plan

- Start in Dewas, MP
- Target: 50 farmers, 25 bookings, 10 transporters, 8 buyers, 30% repeat in 30 days

Rs

Business model

- Planned: 1 to 3% transaction fee or a small listing fee
- Pricing not tested yet
- MVP revenue to date: 0

!

Still unproven

- Transaction frequency
- Retention at scale
- Logistics unit economics
- Paid adoption

What it won

Winner

Polygnan Demo Day

1 of 22

fellows from 4,000+ applicants

318+

registered farmers

Site claim

80%

Week-2 retention

Site claim, across 15+ users

Also selected for the Sarvam AI Startup Program and ICAR SHITIJ 2.0.

Fellowship record (weekly tracker)

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Stage	Week	What was delivered
Problem and research	2 to 3	Market and village visits, interviews with farmers, retailers, buyers and a scientist, Google Form, Five Whys, personas
PRD and MVP plan	4	Problem, users, features, success metrics, lean MVP plan
EYFI and pitch deck	5	30-day earning challenge, video, first pitch deck
MVP v1, then v2	6 and 7	v1 live with tester feedback; v2 redesign; GTM strategy written
Final, Demo Day	8 to 10	Updated deck, final user reviews, final build, reflection and demo videos, pitch; won Demo Day

Evidence: the product

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Item	Link
Live product (final)	saarthimvp.vercel.app/
MVP v1	saarthi-rose.vercel.app/
MVP v2	sarthisetu-two.vercel.app/
GitHub	github.com/godhulivyas-build/Sarthi
UI designs (Stitch)	stitch.withgoogle.com/projects/5742322990560687540

Evidence: decks, videos, research

Saarthi

Item	Link
Pitch deck / updated pitch deck	canva.link/h81hmy0v3v79vx1 and docs.google.com/presentation/d/10_mkFG4dEAb6w1nRmNAHafyaZmck26rN/edit?usp=drive_link
Farmer walkthrough / demo video	youtu.be/AYJJxBXKOrc and drive.google.com/file/d/10Xe11G8FDuK_hPzpjxaMk8oPFY3ESw5c/view?usp=drive_link
Founder story video	drive.google.com/file/d/1MsANbVJ_y9tifjZ8dMO-0XG0lDGflWjT/view?usp=sharing
PRD and MVP plan / user research	drive.google.com/drive/folders/13nMdftUpZ3QJ7Cxi8ErGeUku_z-mHhLk?usp=sharing and drive.google.com/drive/folders/1evdtn059NCcJPe5XbE45S1-zYfehl8Tw?usp=sharing
All Saarthi files	drive.google.com/drive/folders/1uYeCUUOj6Rf6YNMWRk7TxOD1uk0S2FG7?usp=sharing

Success metrics

NORTH STAR METRIC

Completed bookings per active farmer per month

Proposed. Shows whether price visibility turns into a real sale and a real truck booking.

L1 METRIC (PROPOSED)

Farmers who view a price and then book transport or a buyer within 7 days.

L2 METRIC (PROPOSED)

Week-2 and week-4 retention, and share of sessions started by voice.

Thank you for reading.

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DISCLAIMER

Saarthi is my own product. Figures marked as site claims are my own; tracker figures come from the fellowship sheets. Success metrics are proposals, not measured results.

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